

S04-L4 — The Four Objections and How to Ask for a Consignment

Summary. This lesson treats a sales objection as a request for proof rather than an obstacle to overcome, and argues that the four most common objections in an art sales conversation, price, authenticity, future value, and a third-party consultation, each require a different kind of evidence. The central case returns to Brazilian painter Adriana Varejão, already covered in the previous lesson, and adds a second recent auction result to show how a price argument is built from dated comparables. The lesson closes with the mechanics of asking for a consignment, presented as a reverse application of the same principle, offer evidence before asking for a decision.

1. The objection as a request for proof

The literature on commercial practices in the art market documents a consistent pattern among professional dealers and advisors, persuasion works better when the client can reconstruct the reasoning behind a figure rather than having to trust the seller's word. Dylan Lessel, co-director of Perrotin Second Marché, described how his team systematically builds a file with auction results, private-deal references, and price comparables before communicating any valuation to a client, even when the gallery itself is the buyer, [so the buyer can reconstruct how the number was reached](#) instead of simply accepting it.¹ That same logic governs how objections should be handled, each one is an implicit question about what evidence supports a claim, and the professional response supplies that evidence instead of a verbal reassurance.

2. The price comparable, two results in the same band

The case anchoring this lesson returns to Adriana Varejão, a Brazilian artist working in glazed ceramic and paint on motifs drawn from Brazil's colonial history. The previous lesson already established her auction record, GBP 1.1 million at Christie's London on February 16, 2011, roughly [USD 1.78 million at the exchange rate of the time](#),² and a first recent comparable, *Monocromo Redondo Ge*, [sold at Phillips London on June 8, 2026 for USD 374,100](#).³

This lesson adds a second, equally recent comparable, *Monocromo redondo Guan*, which [Phillips New York sold on May 21, 2026 for USD 361,200](#) as part of the same sale series where works by Beatriz Milhazes, Firelei Báez, and Carmen

Herrera also changed hands.⁴ The two 2026 results, three hundred and seventy four thousand one hundred dollars in June and three hundred and sixty one thousand two hundred in May, land in the same price band despite coming from different houses and cities. That agreement between two independent observations is what turns an isolated data point into a defensible pattern for a client, and it is also why the lesson favors recent comparables over the 2011 record, which describes an exceptional sale from more than a decade ago rather than the current price band.

3. Authenticity and future value, different evidence for each question

The authenticity objection is resolved with provenance documentation and, where one exists, the artist's catalogue raisonné. The lesson refers back to the already-covered case of the painting attributed to Tarsila do Amaral, challenged at the SP-Arte fair in São Paulo in April 2024, where a subsequent appraisal [declared the work genuine with a new valuation](#), though a member of the artist's family publicly rejected that conclusion.⁵ The episode illustrates that even a professional authentication may not fully close the discussion, which is why this lesson insists that a provenance file lowers risk without eliminating it, and that on high value pieces the final word belongs to an authentication specialist.

The future-value objection rests on a historical return figure. The joint Bank of America and ArtTactic study of the U.S. art market found that [works held between twenty and twenty five years produced an average annual return of 11%, while those sold before the five year mark averaged -5.7%](#).⁶ The figure describes a market average, not a projection for any specific work, and the lesson is explicit about that distinction before it gets used in front of a client.

4. Asking for a consignment as the reverse application

The fourth objection, the third-party consultation, functions as an opportunity to reinforce the argument with the same evidence file already built. The lesson extends that principle to a different situation, asking a client to consign a work for sale. Carine Karam of Artsy documented that digital buyers prioritize finding [signals of availability, seller identity, and transparency](#) before moving forward with a transaction,⁷ a finding the lesson carries over to the consignment conversation, offering verifiable comparables before asking for a decision reduces the sense of pressure and raises the odds that the owner moves forward with full information.

For client conversations

First, against a price objection, the professional response never defends the figure with the dealer's own judgment, it backs it with at least two recent, dated comparables. Second, against an authenticity doubt, the response leans on verifiable documentation and explicitly acknowledges that documentation's limits, without promising a certainty that does not exist. Third, when a client asks to consult an advisor, the correct response is to make that consultation easier with concrete data, rather than treating it as a sign the sale is slipping away.

Notes

1. Talking Galleries, *Barcelona Symposium 2022*, interview with Dylan Lessel, Perrotin Second Marché, 2022-10-03/04. [Talking Galleries](#). ↵
2. The Art Newspaper, *Women artists lead the way in Brazil*, 2013-09-01. [The Art Newspaper](#). ↵
3. HENI News, market profile of Adriana Varejão, Phillips London result of 2026-06-08. [HENI](#). ↵
4. Phillips, *Modern & Contemporary Art Afternoon Sale*, New York, 2026-05-21, Adriana Varejão lot, *Monocromo redondo Guan*, USD 361,200. [Phillips](#). ↵
5. The Art Newspaper, *Tarsila do Amaral forgery claims at SP-Arte*, 2024-04-08. [The Art Newspaper](#). ↵
6. Bank of America and ArtTactic, *U.S. Art Market Report 2026*, annualized return data by holding period. [Bank of America](#). ↵
7. Talking Galleries, *Barcelona Symposium 2022*, interview with Carine Karam, Artsy, 2022-10-03/04. [Talking Galleries](#). ↵